

CVIN.BIO RESEARCH / MARCH 2026

The Remote Talent Report 2026

34 million Americans now work remotely. Companies are not returning to how things were. This report examines what the data actually says about remote work, hiring, compensation, and retention heading into the second half of the decade.

27%

Fully remote among eligible roles

Stanford SWAA

52%

Hybrid arrangement, knowledge workers

Apollo Technical

36%

New postings with a remote component

LinkedIn Economic Graph

\$12K

Annual savings per remote employee

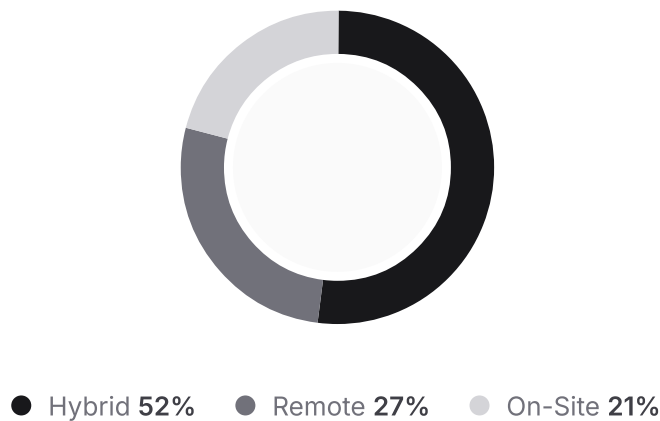
Global Workplace Analytics

The workforce has permanently restructured

Between 2020 and 2023 the share of work-from-home days jumped from 5% to 27%. The most surprising part is not the spike. It is the plateau. Since late 2022 that number has held steady between 25% and 27%. It barely moves anymore.

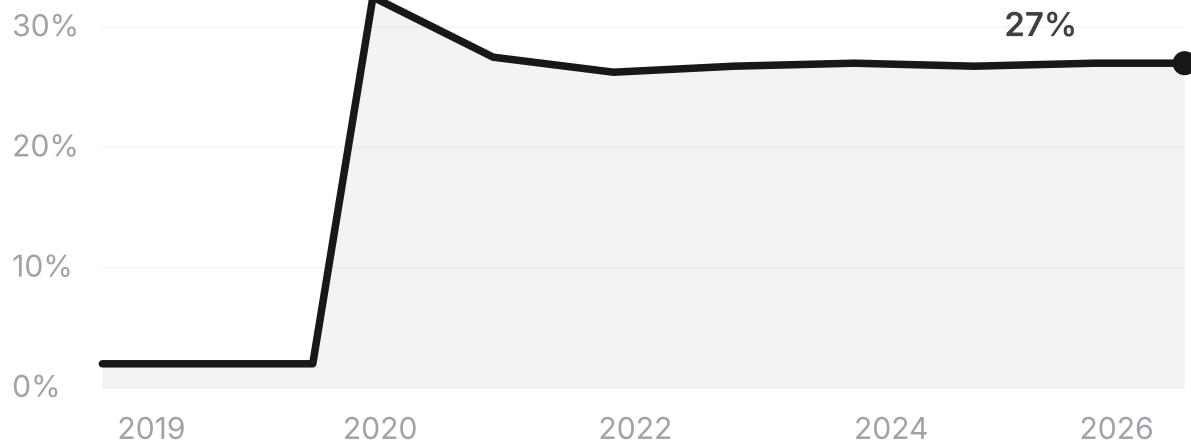
Stanford economists Nicholas Bloom and Steven Davis have tracked this weekly through the Survey of Working Arrangements and Attitudes. Their conclusion is blunt. The structural shift is over. This is the new baseline.

WHERE KNOWLEDGE WORKERS WORK



The share of remote work days has not meaningfully changed since late 2022. The debate is over.

SHARE OF PAID WORK DAYS AT HOME, U.S. FULL-TIME WORKERS



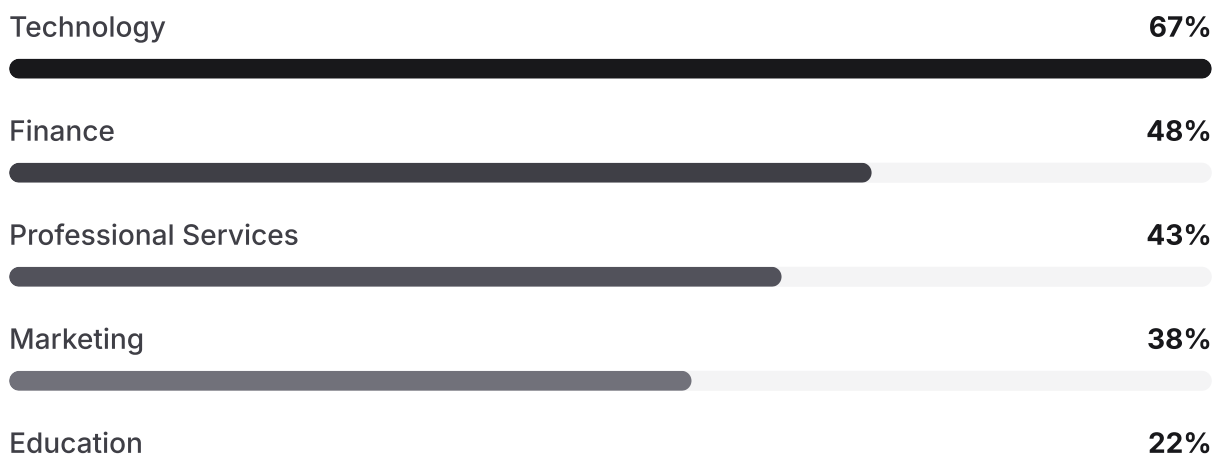
[Stanford WFH Research](#) · [SWAA Survey 2025-2026](#) · [Apollo Technical](#)

Remote hiring is concentrated in specific industries

Technology, finance, and professional services account for the vast majority of remote job postings. Within tech the distribution is heavily skewed toward engineering, product management, and design roles.

Manufacturing, healthcare, and hospitality remain overwhelmingly on-site. The gap between remote-friendly and remote-hostile industries has not narrowed. If anything it has widened.

SHARE OF REMOTE-ELIGIBLE POSTINGS



Healthcare

8%

[LinkedIn Economic Graph](#) · [Glassdoor Economic Research](#) · [Robert Half 2026 Salary Guide](#)

Remote roles now pay more, not less



Several 2026 compensation studies show fully remote roles commanding a 6% to 7% salary premium over equivalent on-site positions. The reason is competition. When a company opens a role to remote candidates it accesses a larger talent pool. But so does every other company.

Harvard Business School research found that the median worker values the option to work from home two or three days per week at roughly 8% of their salary. This creates a negotiation asymmetry that savvy employers exploit.

REMOTE PREMIUM BY ROLE



Average Tech Role

7%



Marketing

4%



Customer Support

2%



For senior engineers at growth-stage startups, the remote salary premium now exceeds 12%.

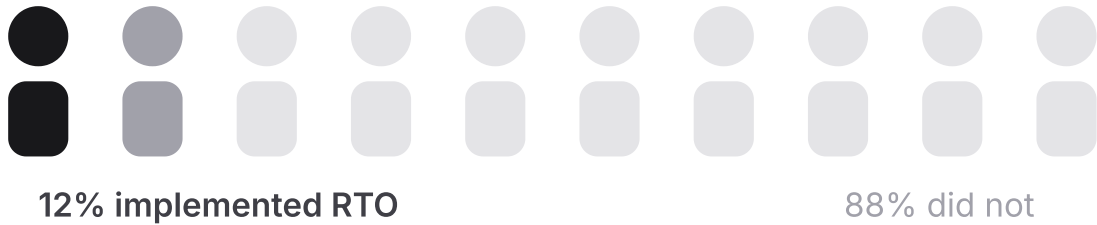
[Levels.fyi 2025 Compensation Report](#) · [NBER Working Paper on WFH Valuation](#) · [Robert Half 2026](#)

Return-to-office mandates are louder than they are effective

Amazon, JPMorgan Chase, and Dell made headlines by mandating five-day office attendance. These mandates obscure a much quieter reality. [Stanford-Federal Reserve data](#) shows that only 12% of executives with hybrid or remote teams implemented an RTO mandate in 2025.

One reading of the data is that RTO mandates function as voluntary attrition programs dressed up as culture initiatives. Dell saw significant application drops after its mandate. Amazon reportedly lost senior engineers to competitors offering flexibility. The companies that issue these mandates know this. Some consider it a feature.

OF 10 EXECUTIVES WITH REMOTE TEAMS, HOW MANY MANDATED RTO?

**12%**

Implemented RTO

3×

Larger candidate pool

64%

Prefer flexibility

[Federal Reserve Survey of Business Uncertainty](#) · [Forbes Advisor 2025-2026](#)

The productivity debate is settled

The [Stanford-Trip.com randomized controlled trial](#) remains the gold standard. In 2022 Nicholas Bloom and his team randomly assigned 1,600 employees to either hybrid or fully in-office schedules. They tracked performance reviews, promotions, and voluntary attrition over two years.

Hybrid workers showed no measurable difference in productivity. They received equivalent performance scores and were promoted at the same rate. But their voluntary quit rate dropped by 33%.

[Microsoft Research](#) tracked 60,000 employees and found that asynchronous communication in remote settings correlated with deeper focused work but reduced cross-team collaboration.

The implication is that remote work favors execution over spontaneous ideation. Companies that need both tend toward structured hybrid where collaboration days are designated and focus days are left uninterrupted.

Hybrid workers showed zero productivity difference but their quit rate dropped by a third.

0%

Productivity difference
in hybrid workers

33%

Reduction in
voluntary quits

60K

Employees tracked
by Microsoft Research

[Bloom et al. \(2024\), Nature](#) · [Microsoft Work Trends Index](#)

What we see in our own data

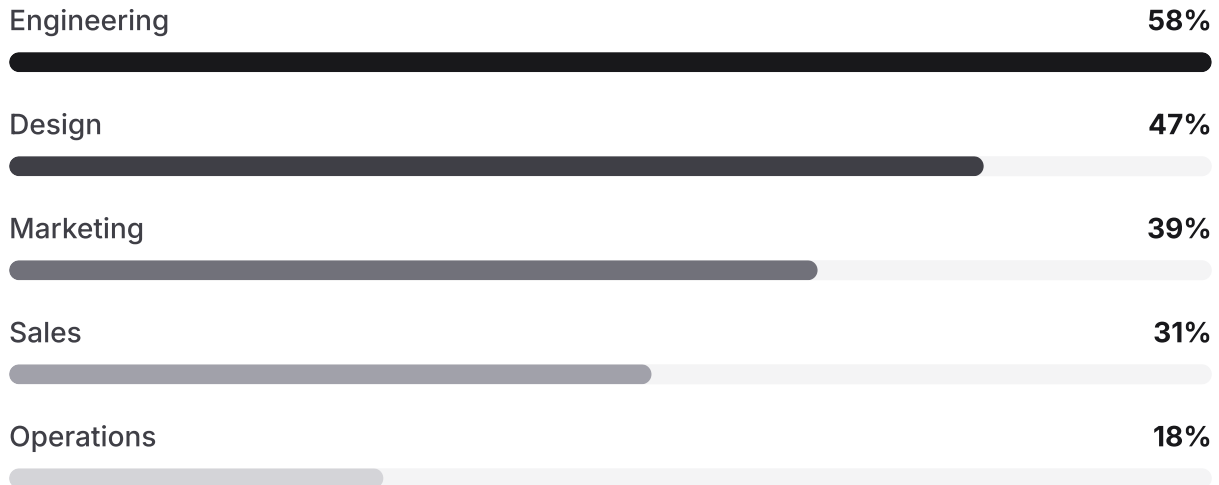
CVin.Bio aggregates 6,000+ live job listings from 60 companies including Stripe, Airbnb, Coinbase, Discord, GitLab, and Spotify. Our data refreshes every three days. Among our current listings, approximately 41% explicitly allow fully remote work. Another 28% are listed as hybrid. The remaining 31% require on-site presence.

LISTINGS BY WORK ARRANGEMENT



● Remote 41% ● Hybrid 28% ● On-Site 31%

% FULLY REMOTE BY DEPARTMENT

Source: [CVin.Bio Job Board](#), internal data, March 2026

Five things that will matter most in the next 18 months

01

Structured hybrid becomes the default employment contract

The ambiguity of "remote-friendly" is ending. Companies will specify exact in-office days during hiring. Candidates will evaluate these terms the same way they evaluate equity or PTO.

02

Geographic pay bands will narrow

Companies competing for scarce roles are discovering that geographic discounts lose candidates to competitors who pay flat national rates. Expect pay-band convergence by 2028.

03

Async-first communication separates elite teams from struggling ones

GitLab, Doist, and Automattic have proven that async-first organizations can operate at scale. The skill gap is not in tools. It is in writing quality.

04

AI will make location even less relevant

Code generation, automated testing, and AI-assisted design are reducing the need for synchronous collaboration. The remaining human contribution shifts toward judgment, taste, and strategy.

05

The resume is the weakest link in remote hiring

When everyone is remote the first impression is a link. Candidates who present themselves through a live, shareable web presence will systematically outperform those who rely on static documents.

Methodology

This report draws on three categories of evidence. First, peer-reviewed research from [Stanford University](#) (Bloom et al.), [Harvard Business School](#), and the [Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta](#). Second, industry surveys from [Robert Half](#), [Glassdoor](#), [LinkedIn Economic Graph](#), [Levels.fyi](#), and [Forbes Advisor](#).

Third, proprietary data from the CVin.Bio job aggregation engine which processes listings from 60 companies across the technology and professional services sectors. All percentage figures for the CVin.Bio dataset are calculated from listings active on March 28, 2026. Salary premium figures are median differentials controlling for role level, experience band, and company stage.

Get the full report

We will send you the complete report with additional data tables, company-level breakdowns, and quarterly update alerts.

Want to see what remote roles are available right now?

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